

Component 1	Component 2
Student completes as a performer or designer	Student completes group performance as a performer or designer Student completes monologue or duologue as a performer or designer

Component 1: Devising

Overview

In this component students will develop their creative and exploratory skills to devise an original performance. The starting point for this devising process will be an extract from a performance text and an influential theatre practitioner.

In their creative explorations, students will learn how text can be manipulated to communicate meaning to audiences and they will begin the process of interpretation. They will gain an understanding of how a new performance could be developed through the practical exploration of the theatrical style and use of conventions of the chosen practitioner.

Content

There are **three** main areas of focus.

- 1) Interpreting, creating and developing a devised piece from **one key extract** from a performance text and applying the methods of **one** practitioner.
- 2) A performance/design realisation of the devised piece.
- 3) Analysing and evaluating the creative process for a devised performance.

Students may complete this component as part of a duologue performance (2 performers) or a group performance (3 – 6 performers).NB: The duologue performance option will be for first teaching September 2025, first assessment 2027.

Students may complete this component either as a performer or as a designer.

The design roles are:

- costume design
- lighting design
- set design
- sound design.

Centres wanting to offer design roles to students should refer to *Appendix 3: Design roles minimum resource guidance requirements for centres*.

Choice of text

Centres have a free choice when selecting the **one key extract** from a performance text. However they must take the following into consideration when choosing the text.

- Be professionally published and substantial, and have a running time of 60 minutes minimum.
- Offer students the opportunity to demonstrate exploratory range and depth that is appropriate to the level of demand for A level study.
- Offer students the opportunity to access the demands of this component as a performer and/or designer.
- Have the degree of challenge, in terms of appropriateness of content, language, complexity of themes, and access to deeper social, historical and cultural contexts to enable students to achieve at A level and meet the Assessment Objectives.
- Cannot be any prescribed text from the Component 3 list.

- Must be different from the text studied in Component 3 so that students study a range of performance texts. This means it must differ in at least one of the following ways:
 - o time period
 - o theatrical convention
 - o thematic content, form or structure
 - o playwright
 - o social, historical and cultural contexts.

For the purposes of this qualification, a **key extract** is defined as a scene or a moment that is significant to the text as a whole and at least 10 minutes in length when performed.

Centres should consider the skills, experience and prior learning of students in choosing text that will engage their interest throughout the considerable preparation and rehearsal time needed for this component.

Choice of practitioner

Centres have a free choice when selecting a practitioner. For the purposes of this qualification, a practitioner is an individual or a company that has an established and defined approach to the creation of performance, and which creates both theatrical performances and theory that informs this practical work. As with the text choice, the choice of practitioner must:

- be chosen so it offers students the opportunity to demonstrate exploratory range and depth to is appropriate to the level of demand for A level study
- offer students the opportunity to access the demands of this component as a performer and/or designer
- have the degree of challenge, in terms of appropriateness of content, language, complexity of themes, access to deeper social, historical and cultural contexts to enable students to achieve at A level and meet the Assessment Objectives.

The choice of practitioner must not be the same as the one chosen in Component 3. However, centres are free to use any of the other practitioners in the Component 3 list for use in Component 1, or centres can choose a different practitioner, for example Katie Mitchell, Frantic Assembly, Grotowski or Forced Entertainment.

Centres are reminded that they must complete the online form regarding text and practitioner choices, please refer to *page 7* for details.

Duologue / Group Requirements

Duologue time limits

A duologue must contain 2 performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per duologue.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that duologues must complete a minimum performance time of 5 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the duologue has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group sizes and time limits

Students must work in a group. Groups must have between **three** and **six** performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per group.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that groups must complete a minimum performance time of 6 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the group has sufficient time to evidence their skills for this component.

Group size	Recommended minimum performance times	Maximum performance times
2 performance students (duologue)	10 minutes	12 minutes
3–4 performance students	15 minutes	20 minutes
5–6 performance students	20 minutes	30 minutes

Centres should be aware that performance times that are between the regulatory minimum (6 minutes) and the recommended minimums (15 or 20 minutes) may not allow students to evidence their skills fully in order to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Meeting the performance timings

Students (performance and design) who do not meet the regulatory minimum performance requirement of 6 minutes will be assessed by teachers against the assessment criteria on *pages 27, 29, 31 and 32*; however students will not be able to achieve beyond Level 2.

Teachers will be required to stop marking after the maximum performance time has passed.

Failure to accurately record the performance times on the authentication sheet (see *Appendix 1*) may result in staff/centre malpractice. For further information about this, please see the *Administration and general information* section in this specification.

1) Devising: interpreting, creating and developing from a complete text and applying the methods of a practitioner

Devising from text is not a re-interpretation of the original text performed in a different style, genre or time period/setting. It must be completely original work which uses the one key extract as a source for ideas only.

Students should undertake exploration of one key extract from a performance text where they interpret, create and develop ideas with the aim of devising an original piece for performance. This exploration should involve placing the key extract in the context of the whole text and also an investigation of one practitioner, in order to apply their methods to the devised piece. There are no limits to the scope of the interpretation. However, students must be given opportunities to know and understand how a specific interpretative process can be developed from given sources and how key elements of a performance text and practitioner methodology can remain a part of the creative process of devising. They must also explore the theatrical practices and processes involved in interpreting a text.

Students should be given the opportunity to devise in a collaborative context, so that they establish an ensemble where ideas and methods are shared and developed. Although the starting point for this work is given, students can build in other stimuli and other practitioners as appropriate.

Before starting their own process of interpreting and devising, students should take part in teacher-led workshops and classes that define the elements of interpretive work on text and practice, including:

- deconstruction of text: analysis of themes, content, structure
- key scenes or turning points in the narrative
- relationship with audience; the nature of the communication
- style of the text and how it fits into a wider genre
- character and characterisation.

Students must develop a range of practical techniques and skills needed to develop and realise the devised performance. The devised performance could incorporate one or more of the following elements of the key extract:

- form
- structure
- character(s)
- dialogue
- themes/issues and ideas.

The influence of the **chosen practitioner** must be evident in the devised performance and this can be shown through application of their methodologies, approaches, theatrical style and/or use of conventions. These could incorporate one or more of the following elements:

- imitate or emulate the performance style and/or use of theatrical conventions of the practitioner
- implement the working methodology/methodologies (evidenced through the portfolio and the performance)
- adapting the text to match the philosophy of the practitioner's performance style and/or use of theatrical conventions
- show some key moments from a practitioner's oeuvre in the performance.

Workshops and classes need to give students the opportunity to build these skills and techniques. These workshops could explore the work of companies, practitioners and individual artists who specialise in devising new work and then apply these ways of working to the stimulus.

Knowledge and understanding

Students must acquire, develop and apply knowledge and understanding to be able to:

- apply research to inform practical work by organising and researching topics, presenting findings, finding narratives and stories, photographs and films that illustrate the themes and ideas
- select key aspects of their research to be put into their original piece
- deconstruct the dramatic elements that make up a performance text
- explore how meaning in performance texts can be informed by social, historical and cultural contexts
- isolate specific themes and ideas, deciding what themes are to be emphasised
- connect their own experiences of live theatre to their own practice and decisions, applying relevant depth of research, independent thought and analysis
- select an appropriate style and genre, possibly connected to the chosen practitioner
- understand the impact they want to have on an audience by the form and style they are using
- shape the drama giving considerations to pace, tempo, order of scenes, finished scripts, desired impact on audience, alternative theatre spaces.

Also students must know how **performance texts** are constructed to conveying meaning through:

- style, structure, language and stage directions
- character construction and interpretation
- use of performance space and spatial relationships on stage
- relationships between performers and audience
- use of design elements.

In addition to this for the **practitioner**, students must acquire, develop and apply knowledge and understanding to be able to:

- know how a practice developed in a different social, historical and cultural context can be understood and adapted to a contemporary age and audience
- make detailed connections between theory and practice in a range of periods, theatrical styles, social, historical and cultural contexts
- recognise and apply the practitioner methodology to their own work.

They must acquire knowledge and understanding of how their **chosen practitioner** has used the following to convey meaning through:

- the social and historical contexts that shaped the theatre practice
- the ideas, theatrical purpose, practice and working methodologies underpinning their work
- the realisation of their artistic intention
- the use of theatrical style and use of conventions
- collaboration with and influence on other practitioners
- how the relationship with audiences is defined in theory and then carried out in practice.

Devising skills

The processes outlined above will equip students with appropriate devising skills. These skills can be summarised as being able to help realise artistic intention through:

- deconstructing ideas, themes and narratives that make up the stimuli
- developing methods that interpret the stimuli, being able to *reposition* it and see it differently
- carrying out in-depth research to inform and develop ideas and creativity
- giving and responding to ideas in a collaborative context.

Students can develop their exploratory skills through:

- workshops
- rehearsal
- taught classes
- individual research
- watching live theatre.

2) The group / duologue devised performance/design realisation

At the culmination of their interpreting, creating and developing process, students must perform their devised piece or realise a design during the performance (please see the design roles section below for more information relating to designers). The rehearsal process should be teacher-led and the performance should take place in front of an appropriate audience.

Centres are free to identify the audience and venue for the performance, this could include:

- performance to the rest of the class or another class within the centre
- performance to an invited external audience.

Performers must acquire, develop and apply the following skills:

- refining and amending work in progress with the aim to realising their artistic intentions
- rehearsing and learning lines
- characterisation through:
 - vocal expression: use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection
 - physicality: use of space, gesture, stillness and stance
- contact, relationships and communication with other performers on stage (proxemics)
- communication and engagement with the audience.

Students must be supervised when developing these processes. Teachers should adopt a facilitating role for the devised performance(s) but they are **not** allowed to direct performance(s). They can give guidance during the practical work and the preparation for the performance(s) but not during the performance(s).

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **allowed** to:

- help students with interpreting assessment information, e.g. explaining the assessment criteria and the requirements of the component
- intervene if a health and safety issue arises
- intervene if a risk to security of evidence arises
- undertake a management role in relation to managing time, space, resources
- ask questions to stimulate independent thought without leading students.

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **not allowed** to:

- offer coaching
- direct students
- undertake an artistic/creative role
- give solutions to artistic/creative problems
- make artistic/creative decisions.

Students should take into consideration any health and safety implications as appropriate.

3) Analysis and evaluation the creative process and devised performance

All students must acquire and apply the ability to analyse and evaluate the process of creating and developing their own live theatrical work and the effectiveness of the outcome. Students must analyse and evaluate:

- ideas explored and research undertaken
- decisions made and the rationale behind them
- their collaborative involvement
- content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- the final performance and the effectiveness of their contribution to it
- the realisation of their intentions.

All students must also know and understand, and be able to use appropriate subject-specific terminology in their analysis and evaluation.

Design roles

Designers are expected to work collaboratively with performers within their chosen area of design.

Where a student is assessed in the role of a designer, it is their design skill that is the focus of the assessment, rather than their technical competence in the operation or use of

equipment. Designs elements should be suitably theatrical and work in sympathy with other design features (if appropriate). Designs should also take into consideration actor/audience relationships and health and safety implications as appropriate.

Designers will be expected to produce evidence for the portfolio of their design skills that reflect the context of the selected elements of the text and the methods of the influential theatre practitioner; these skills will be applied in the devised performance.

There is a maximum of one designer per role, per group/duologue.

Designers must also acquire, develop and apply the following skills:

- work collaboratively within the devising ensemble
- make appropriate judgements during the devising process
- develop and articulate a design concept
- make appropriate design choices within the context of a performance to an audience
- use and apply design skills to contribute to the performance as a whole
- demonstrate the ability to apply design skills and materials effectively in the context of a performance to an audience.

A list of the requirements for each design skill for this component is given on the next page.